

FOR THE DANCE **Ransom Note**

RANSOM NOTE

Rachel Bell 2008

Gliding ♩. = 104

Em C G D Em Em/D

5 C G Bm 1. C D 2. C

10 Bm C G D

14 Bm C G 1. D 2. D



I wrote this dance for a beginning group of dancers at Vanderbilt University in 2015 and called it “The Commodore”—a reference to Vanderbilt’s unusual school mascot. I wanted a simple dance with a straightforward progression. I was teaching to recorded music and used whatever jig was handy. Calling at the Old Songs Festival a few years later, however, I suddenly found myself needing a simple dance and asked Rachel, who was in the band, to pick a jig, and she played her tune, “Ransom Note.” Since then, I’ve paired this choreography to her tune and changed the title to match the tune name. I never intended this dance to be released into the mainstream English dance world—seeing it more as a tool for beginners—so imagine my surprise to learn that Brad Foster taught it at the New London Assembly!